

Impact Low · Difficulty Medium · Misuse risk It fails when you return abruptly with no bridge, recite every earlier detail, or use

THE MOVE

Callback marker + earlier thread + light reason + small invitation -> Can I go back to something you said earlier — X? I did not want to lose that. What was behind it? -> You mentioned X before. That sounded important. Do you want to say more ?

START HERE

Can I come back to the part where you said X?

SAY THIS

Quick callbacks	"Quick callback to X — what did you mean by that?"
Social / personal	"You said earlier the trip was a weird reset. Can I come back to that? Weird in what way?"
Meetings / decisions	"Can I loop back to the risk you named earlier? I do not want it to disappear under the timeline discussion."
Digital / threaded	"Threading back to your point about onboarding — what was the main friction?"
Careful / release	"No need to go there if it is not useful."
Sensitive / conflict	"I want to be careful here. You mentioned X earlier — is it useful to return to that, or should we stay with the current issue?"

AVOID

- The person has clearly signalled that the topic is closed.
- The earlier point was sensitive and the relationship does not support returning to it.
- You would be using the callback to corner, expose, sell, pressure, or win an argument.

REMEMBER

The best callback bridge sounds like care, not control.